The Tang Dynasty

The Tang Dynasty ruled from 618 to 907 CE and this time period is often referred to as China's Golden Era. The emperor continued running the government as it had been done previously but with a few improvements. He stopped spending on excessive building projects and military campaigns. He was wise enough not repeat his predecessor's mistakes. Unfortunately, he was assassinated in 626 CE by his son Li Shimin who also murdered his siblings and several individuals in the aristocracy. He declared himself Emperor Taizhong and ordered Buddhist temples to be erected where the dead had fallen in battle. He claimed the Mandate of Heaven had been given to him and that whomever he had slain would become his advisor in the hereafter. Despite the fact that he usurped his way to the throne, he proved himself to be a capable emperor and was skilled in military tactics. This is probably why he was not challenged by any warlords or assassinated like many of his predecessors.

Emperor Taizhong continued running the country with much of the same policies that had popularized the Sui Dynasty's government. We see this particularly in his new legal codes, which he borrowed greatly from Sui ideas. He was critical of weak punishments for specific crimes and felt that the punishments should be harsher. He disregarded his father's foreign policies and allowed a succession of military campaigns to take place that expanded the Chinese borders.

The Silk Road became more prosperous and trading links to the west were strengthened. At this time, the Roman Empire had fallen due to its own wars. It was replaced by the Byzantine Empire that was in favor of silk being transported from China to the west. In 712 CE, when Emperor Xuanzong came to power, China was the wealthiest and most populous civilization in the world. The government was able to build an army of epic proportions, which was strong enough to crush both internal and external threats. During the Tang Dynasty, the arts, sciences and technology sectors grew even more. Many sculptures including those depicting Chinese ancestors were carved during this time.